

Workstream 01 — Podcast Outreach

paradigmconsulting.io

What this workstream does

Podcast appearances are the highest-leverage authority asset Paradigm can produce in the next 90 days. One 45-minute interview puts a founder's voice in front of a pre-qualified audience, generates a backlink from the show's site and shownotes, gives Google and the LLMs new "this person is an authority on X" training data, and creates a relationship with a host that warms up every future ask (guest posts, intros, referrals).

The cost is time: ~90 minutes to pitch, ~60 minutes to record, ~30 minutes post-publication promotion. Per founder, that is roughly four hours per booked appearance — and the asset compounds for years.

This workstream is run by an operator pitching under each founder's name. The founders do not pitch their own shows. They show up, record, and promote.

Per-founder target list

Three founders, three domains. Each list below is the first 90 days of pitching. Do not pitch outside this list until reply rate is measured on the warm ones.

Ari Barton — Compliance, ROSCA, multi-state licensing, classification

Target audiences: direct selling executives, insurance executives, MLM operators, agency owners with reps, founders scaling sales orgs. Ari is the only one on the team who can credibly speak as a compliance practitioner — pitches lean on "ROSCA framework specialist, \$2.5B+ in structured sales volume, 200,000+ distributors."

Tier 1 (warm match, pitch first):

- **Direct Selling News Podcast** (DSN; Direct Selling News) — compliance and regulatory beat
- **The DSWA Voices Podcast** (Direct Selling Women's Alliance) — compliance for women-led DS orgs
- **Build It Backwards** (direct sales operators)
- **The MLM Tribune Podcast** — channel-native audience
- **Insurance Pro Shop** — insurance agency owners scaling reps
- **The Insurance Town Podcast** — agency compliance angle

- **Producer's Edge** (insurance) — agent classification and licensing
- **Great Women in Compliance** (corporate compliance, broader B2B reach)

Tier 2 (broader B2B reach, pitch after Tier 1 lands):

- **Compliance Perspectives** (Society of Corporate Compliance and Ethics)
- **The Compliance Podcast Network** (Tom Fox)
- **Adventures in Compliance** (broad reach in corporate compliance)
- **The Lawyer's Edge / Esquire's Edge** — when a legal angle (ROSCA, classification) is timely
- **JD Supra "Legal Issues Today"** (when JD Supra is also a guest content target)

Pitch angle examples:

- *"Why the 2024 DOL classification rule is going to force 70% of direct-sales orgs to restructure their rep relationships — and what the operators who restructured first are already doing differently."*
- *"The compliance gaps that show up in M&A diligence on insurance agencies — and what kills the deal."*
- *"What ROSCA enforcement actually targets in 2026 — and the 3 documentation gaps that turn a complaint into a multi-month investigation."*

Matt Rosa — Culture, retention, rep-driven org design, leadership

Target audiences: founders and CEOs of service businesses, sales-org operators, HR leaders, executive coaches, distributor and rep network leaders. Matt's frame is "Tattoo Culture" — culture that is permanent, embedded, operates without founder presence.

Tier 1:

- **Sales Gravy** (Jeb Blount) — sales culture and rep retention
- **The Brutal Truth About Sales & Selling**
- **Selling From the Heart Podcast**
- **The Modern People Leader** — HR and culture
- **Coaching for Leaders** (Dave Stachowiak)
- **The EntreLeadership Podcast** (Dave Ramsey) — culture for owner-operators
- **The Direct Approach** (direct sales culture)
- **The Build Show** (MLM/DS operator audience)

Tier 2:

- **The Knowledge Project** (Shane Parrish) — broader business audience
- **How I Built This** (NPR) — story arc only if the Paradigm story is tight enough
- **Lenny's Podcast** — product/growth audience that intersects with org design
- **WorkLife with Adam Grant** (TED) — high bar, pitch only with a fresh angle
- **The Marketing Companion**

- **Recruiting Future** — recruiting/retention crossover

Pitch angle examples:

- *"The retention math behind why your top 10% of reps drives 60-70% of your revenue — and the three culture levers that actually move it."*
- *"Why most 'culture' work fails in distributed sales orgs (and the 4 things Tattoo Culture installs that traditional culture programs don't)."*
- *"What happens to a sales org when the founder steps back — and the cultural infrastructure that keeps performance from collapsing."*

Jay Awal — AI, agentic workflows, systems architecture for service businesses

Target audiences: service-business operators (HVAC, plumbing, electrical, roofing, solar), agency owners, dispatch managers, ops leaders, technical co-founders. Jay's frame: "the operating layer over the tools service businesses already pay for."

Tier 1:

- **Service Business Mastery Podcast** — HVAC/plumbing operator audience
- **The Profitable Solar Business** (or **Solar Maverick**)
- **The HVAC Tactical Podcast**
- **Successful Contractor** (Service Roundtable)
- **The Roofer Show**
- **The Modern Operator** (service business ops)
- **HVAC School Podcast**
- **Pest Geek Podcast** (pest control vertical, AI for dispatch is a natural fit)

Tier 2:

- **Practical AI** (Changelog) — high-trust audience but more technical than ideal
- **The AI Podcast** (NVIDIA)
- **No Priors** — broader AI audience
- **The Tim Ferriss Show** — top-tier; only with a singular narrative angle
- **Acquired** — only if a service-business AI rollup story is tight
- **Lenny's Podcast** — product/growth crossover for tech-forward operators
- **Marketing Over Coffee**
- **The Operations Room** (Hubspot for Startups)

Pitch angle examples:

- *"How a 40-truck HVAC operation cut dispatch time by 35% by putting an agentic layer over the FSM they already had — no new software."*
- *"Why agentic workflows beat 'AI implementation' for service businesses — and the operating principle behind every one we've built."*

- *"The three jobs an AI layer should do in a service business in 2026 — and the three it shouldn't."*
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Sourcing process

This is the part most operators get wrong. Sourcing podcasts is not a Google search. It is a structured search across three channels, ranked by reply rate.

1. Listen Notes (highest reply rate)

- listennotes.com — search by topic, filter by recency (last 60 days of episodes), audience size (1k+ listeners per episode), and "accepts guests."
- For each result, open the host's profile, find their direct email (usually in show notes or [show.com/contact](#)).
- Save: show name, host name, host email, audience estimate, last episode date, three recent episode topics (proves you actually listened).

2. Spotify + Apple category search

- Browse the relevant category (Business, Marketing, Entrepreneurship, Industry-specific).
- Sort by "popularity" or "new and noteworthy" — these are the shows actively booking guests.
- For each candidate, click through to the show's website to find the booking process.

3. Cross-reference Apollo and LinkedIn

- Once you have a host name, run them through Apollo to find a verified email if the show's contact page doesn't list one.
- Connect on LinkedIn — do NOT pitch in the connection request. Connect first, pitch via email later. LinkedIn pitches at this stage tank reply rate.

Target: 30 sourced shows per founder before the first pitch goes out. This is one operator-day of sourcing per founder.

Pitch templates

Every pitch is one operator pitching under one founder's name. Keep it under 150 words, name a specific recent episode, lead with the angle, end with a soft ask.

Template — Tier 1 pitch

Subject: Quick pitch for the show – [SPECIFIC ANGLE]

Hi [HOST FIRST NAME],

I caught your episode with [RECENT GUEST] on [SPECIFIC TOPIC] last [TIMEFRAME] – [ONE SENTENCE ON WHAT LANDED, SPECIFIC, NOT GENERIC].

I'm writing on behalf of [FOUNDER FULL NAME], [TITLE] at Paradigm Consulting. [FOUNDER FIRST NAME] has [ONE-LINE CREDENTIAL – e.g., "structured compliance frameworks for over \$2.5B in sales volume across direct selling and insurance"].

The angle I'd pitch for your audience is:

> [SPECIFIC EPISODE ANGLE – 1-2 sentences, framed as a question your audience > would want answered]

Happy to send three more angles if this one isn't a fit. [FOUNDER FIRST NAME]'s bio is at [https://paradigmconsulting.io/team#\[ANCHOR\]](https://paradigmconsulting.io/team#[ANCHOR]) if you want to take a look.

Worth a 20-minute call to see if there's a fit?

[OPERATOR NAME]
on behalf of [FOUNDER FIRST NAME] | Paradigm Consulting

Template — Warm follow-up after non-reply (day 5)

Subject: Re: [ORIGINAL SUBJECT]

Hi [HOST FIRST NAME] – wanted to bump this up.

If the original angle wasn't right, two others [FOUNDER FIRST NAME] could speak to:

1. [SECOND ANGLE – 1 sentence]
2. [THIRD ANGLE – 1 sentence]

Or if the timing's just off, no concern – happy to circle back in a couple months.

[OPERATOR NAME]

Template — Booking-confirmed follow-up

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Subject: [SHOW NAME] – recording prep + bio + headshot

Hi [HOST FIRST NAME],

Confirming the [DATE / TIME / TIMEZONE] recording. Below are the assets
your producer will need:

- Bio (short): [3-SENTENCE BIO]
- Bio (long): https://paradigmconsulting.io/team#[ANCHOR]
- Headshot (1200x1200, transparent bg): [LINK]
- One-line title for the episode: [SUGGESTED TITLE]
- Three things I'll commit to covering on the show: [THREE BULLETS]

Anything else you want from me before we record?

[FOUNDER FIRST NAME]
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Pre-record prep checklist (founder-side)

The day before recording, the founder spends 30 minutes prepping:

- ☐ Listen to the last two episodes of the show. Note host's interview style and recurring questions.
- ☐ Review the three committed talking points. Have one specific story or stat for each.
- ☐ Have the Paradigm one-liner ready: "Paradigm Consulting installs compliance, culture, and technology systems for service businesses scaling between \$5M and \$50M."
- ☐ Have a written CTA the host can read at the end: "Listeners can find the [risk map / culture systems / tech systems] page at [paradigmconsulting.io/\[slug\]](https://paradigmconsulting.io/[slug])."
- ☐ Test mic, lighting, and internet. Backup hotspot if WFH.
- ☐ Block 30 min after recording for any retakes the host requests.

Post-publication promotion

The episode is the asset. The promotion is what makes the asset compound.

When an episode goes live:

1. **LinkedIn post under the founder's profile.** Tag the host. Quote one specific moment. Link to the episode. Native upload (don't link out as primary; LinkedIn de-ranks external links — embed the audio or post the quote with the link in comment).

2. **Email to Paradigm list.** One paragraph + episode link.
3. **Add to /team page** — each founder's bio gets a "Recent appearances" list. Update after every published episode.
4. **Add to internal tracker.** Date, show, host, episode URL, branded search lift over 30 days (Google Search Console), inbound mentions (LinkedIn search), referral traffic to paradigmconsulting.io.

Tracking spreadsheet schema

One row per show, one tab per founder.

Column	Notes
Show name	
Host name	
Host email	
Listen Notes URL	
Audience estimate	From Listen Notes
Date sourced	
Pitch sent date	
First reply date	
Reply type	replied yes / replied no / replied maybe-later / no reply
Booking date	
Recording date	
Episode publication date	
Episode URL	
Referring domain captured	YES/NO — confirm shownotes link back to paradigmconsulting.io
30-day branded search lift	From GSC, compare 30 days before vs 30 days after publication
Inbound from listeners	Note any direct outreach citing the episode

Cadence and quotas

- **Sourcing:** 30 shows per founder, refreshed monthly. Stop sourcing once 30 unpitched targets are in the queue.
- **Pitching:** 2-3 pitches per founder per week. 6-9 total per week.
- **Follow-up:** Day 5 if no reply. Day 14 if no reply to follow-up. Then move to "circle back in 3 months" list.
- **Booking → recording lag:** Target < 21 days. Longer lags lose energy.
- **Recording → publication lag:** Most shows publish 2-6 weeks after recording. Tracked but not in our control.

Reply rate benchmarks:

- **Below 5%:** Pitch quality or list quality is wrong. Pause and audit. Either the angle is generic, the host doesn't book outside guests, or the show is bigger than the pitch is positioned for.
- **5-12%:** Working. Continue.
- **Above 15%:** Either the list is too warm (you're under-pitching) or the angles are exceptionally good. Double volume.

When this is working

- 3-5 booked recordings per month across all three founders (30-50% reply rate on a well-warmed list).
- 2+ published episodes per month after the lag washes out.
- Branded search for "Paradigm Consulting" + founder names rising month-over-month in GSC.
- First inbound DM or email citing a specific episode within 60 days of the first published appearance.